

THEFAB COOKBOOK - VOLUME I

# Potatoes Gratin à la Girardet

No cheese, no shortcuts: just potatoes, garlic, cream and muscade. A precise, luxurious gratin where the potatoes become tender and the top turns deeply golden.

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|-------------|----------------|----------------|------------------------------|
| Serves<br>6 | Prep<br>20 min | Cook<br>1 h 15 | Style<br>Classic / no cheese |
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TheFAB studio note

The discipline is in what you do not add. No cheese inside: the luxury comes from cream, garlic, nutmeg and slow cooking.

Ingredients

- 1.3 kg waxy potatoes, peeled
- 600-700 ml full cream
- 2 garlic cloves, halved
- 30 g butter, for the dish
- Freshly grated nutmeg / muscade
- Fine sea salt
- Freshly ground white or black pepper

Method

- 1 Heat the oven to 160°C. Rub a gratin dish generously with the cut garlic, then butter it.
- 2 Slice the potatoes very thinly, ideally 2 mm. Do not rinse them; the starch helps bind the cream.
- 3 Layer the potatoes neatly in the dish, seasoning each layer with salt, pepper and a little grated nutmeg.
- 4 Pour over enough cream to almost cover the potatoes, pressing the surface gently so the cream spreads between the slices.
- 5 Bake slowly for about 1 hour 15 minutes, until the potatoes are completely tender and the top is golden. If the top colours too fast, cover loosely with foil.
- 6 Let the gratin rest 10 minutes before serving. It should hold together softly, with cream reduced into the potatoes rather than flooding the plate.

Proposed wine pairing

A pairing designed to support the main character of the dish rather than overpower it.

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|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Best match   | White Burgundy or another elegant Chardonnay with freshness rather than heavy oak.                                                     |
| Also works   | Swiss Chasselas from Lavaux, especially Dezelay or Epesses; Alsace Pinot Gris; light Pinot Noir if the gratin accompanies meat.        |
| Why it works | Cream needs acidity and texture. Nutmeg, garlic and slow-cooked potato pair beautifully with mineral whites and restrained Chardonnay. |
| Serving note | Serve the white cool but not ice-cold. Too much oak can make the cream feel heavier.                                                   |

Personal adjustment: choose a bottle you would happily drink even without the dish. Pairing should amplify pleasure, not become an exam.